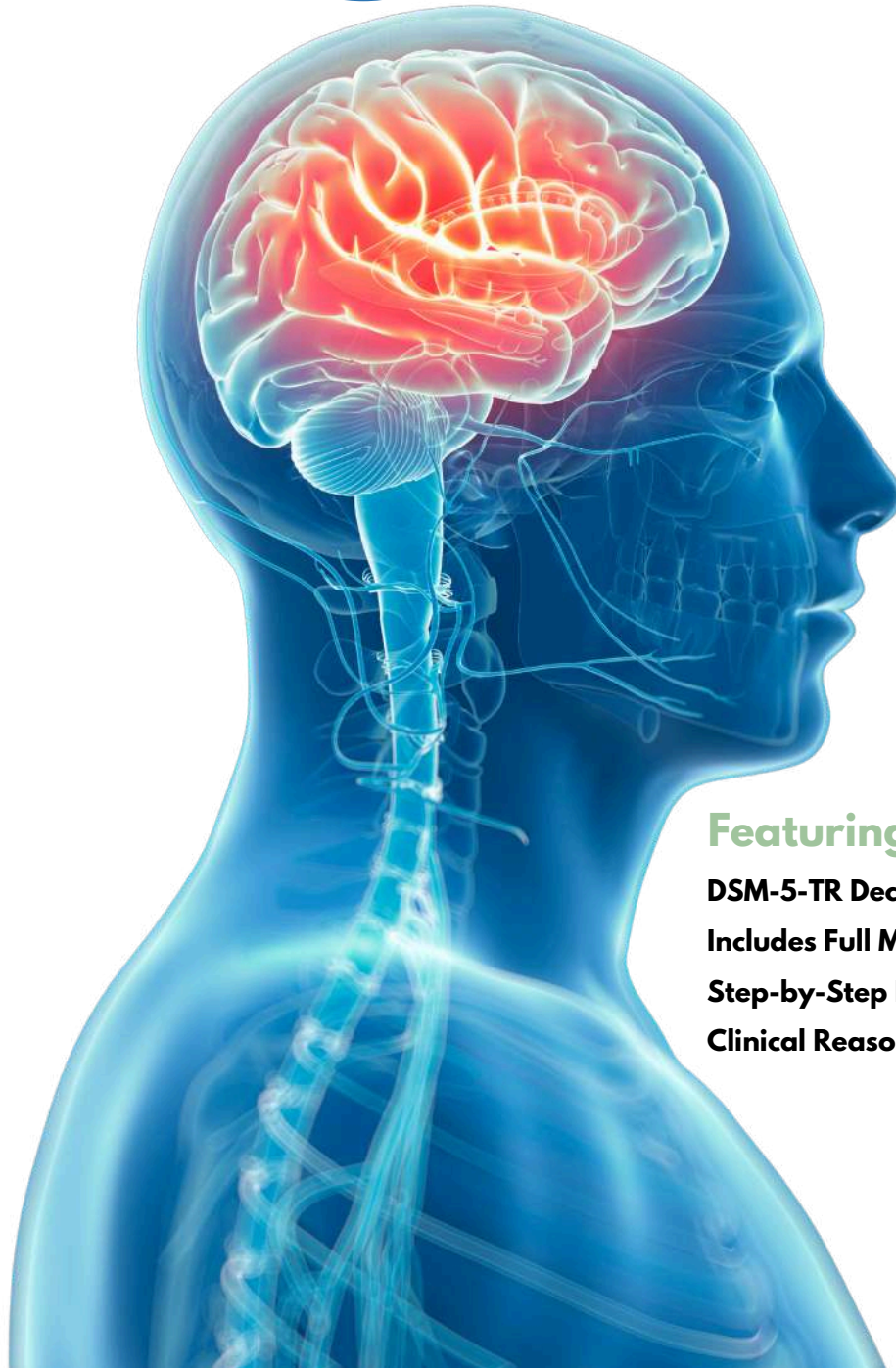


Tonia Ojomo, MSN, BSN, RN

PSYCHIATRIC ASSESSMENT MASTERY



Featuring

DSM-5-TR Decision Trees

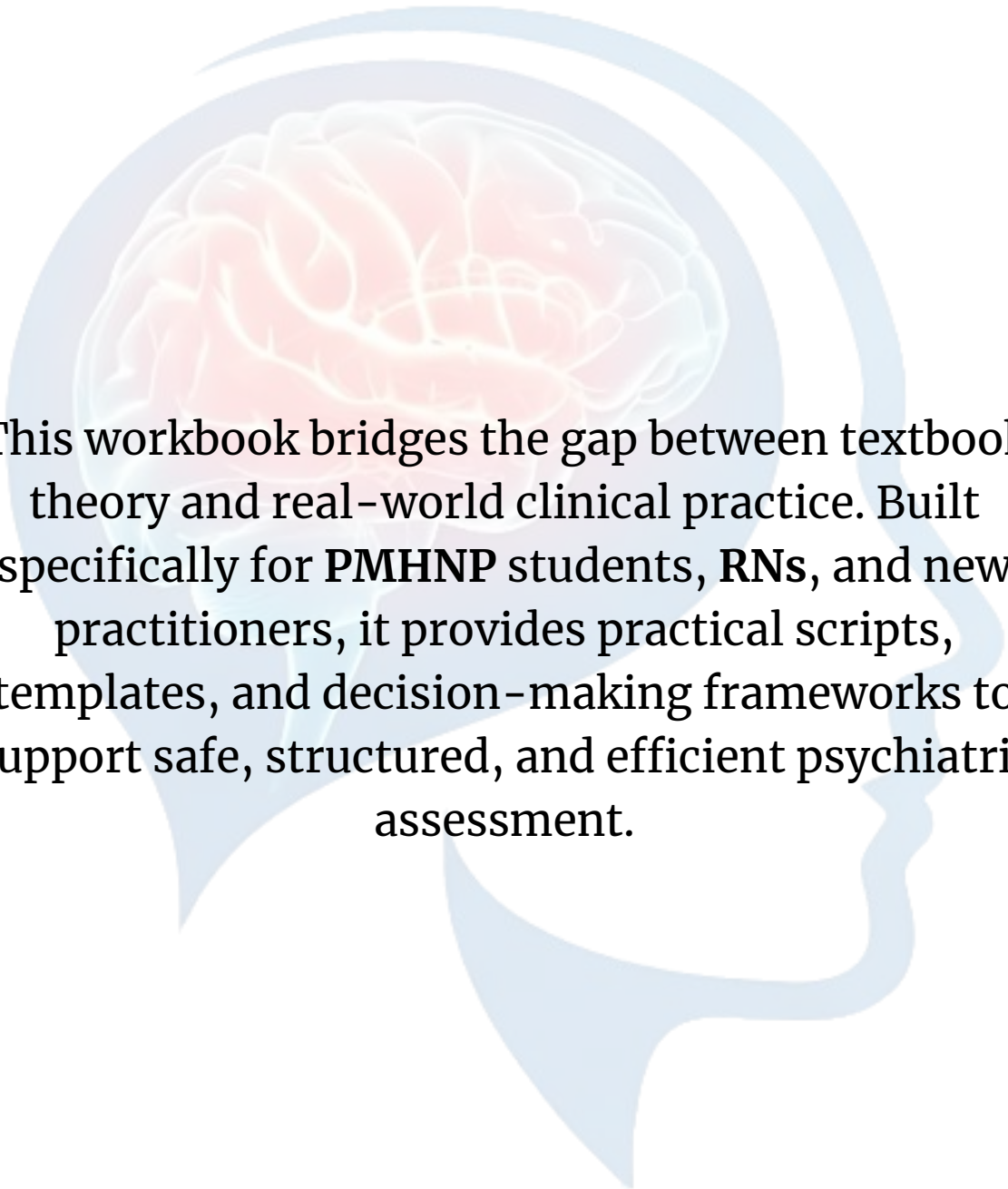
Includes Full MSE Checklists

Step-by-Step Interview Scripts

Clinical Reasoning & SOAP Guides

Download the Digital Toolkit & Templates at:

www.psychassessmentguide.com



This workbook bridges the gap between textbook theory and real-world clinical practice. Built specifically for **PMHNP** students, **RNs**, and new practitioners, it provides practical scripts, templates, and decision-making frameworks to support safe, structured, and efficient psychiatric assessment.

What This Is / What This Is Not



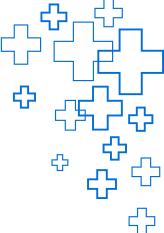
WHAT THIS IS

- ▶ **Volume 1 of Psychiatric Assessment Mastery:** A focused guide on Psychosis & Mood Disorders.
 - ▶ **A Clinical Workflow System:** Designed to improve psychiatric interviewing, MSE documentation, diagnostic reasoning, and **SOAP** writing.
 - ▶ **For Active Learners:** Built for PMHNP students, NPs, RNs, and clinicians who want a repeatable, structured framework for practice.
 - ▶ **Real-World Support:** A tool meant to be used during clinical practicum, exam preparation, and daily documentation.
-



WHAT THIS IS NOT

- ▶ **Not a Substitute for Supervision:** Always follow your institutional policies, clinical protocols, and attending physician/supervisor guidance.
 - ▶ **Not a DSM-5-TR Replacement:** This book teaches pattern recognition and clinical reasoning. You must still verify specific criteria in the full DSM-5-TR text.
 - ▶ **Not a Theory Book:** This is not a text you read once and put away. It is a workbook designed for active use and repetition.
-



How to Think Like a Psychiatric Clinician

A Simple Guide for Clear Clinical Thinking

Thinking like a psychiatric clinician does not mean using big medical words or memorizing the DSM. It means learning how to:

- ✓ Listen carefully
- ✓ Notice patterns
- ✓ Ask the right questions
- ✓ Stay calm and curious
- ✓ Connect symptoms to possible explanations

Start With Curiosity, Not Diagnosis

One of the most common mistakes new clinicians make is trying to name a diagnosis too quickly. Your job is to understand the patient's story first. The diagnosis comes later.

Instead of asking:

What diagnosis is this?

Ask:

What is this person experiencing right now?

Use This Simple 4-Step Thinking Process

Step 1: Listen to the Story

- ✓ Listen carefully
- ✓ Notice patterns
- ✓ Ask the right questions
- ✓ Stay calm and curious

Step 2: Observe What You See

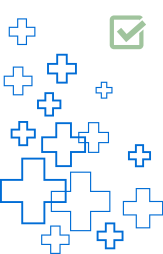
- ✓ Appearance and behavior
- ✓ Eye contact, speech speed and tone
- ✓ Mood and emotional expression
- ✓ Movement (restless, slowed, calm)

Step 3: Identify Key Patterns

- ✓ Do the symptoms cluster together?
- ✓ Is there a clear timeline?
- ✓ Is there an immediate safety risk?
- ✓ How is the patient's functioning being affected?

Step 4: Ask, "What Could Explain This?"

- ✓ Could this be depression?
- ✓ Medication side effects?
- ✓ Anxiety or Trauma-related?
- ✓ Medical causes or Substance use?



Worksheet: Build Your Own Phrase Bank

Worksheet: Build Your Own Phrase Bank

Fill this in with your preferred wording. Keep the final version in a note app or printed binder.

Opening script

Empathy statement #1

Empathy statement #2

Redirection phrase

Risk documentation phrase

Differential phrase

Closing script

The Ultimate Clinical Companion

PSYCHIATRIC ASSESSMENT MASTERY

Psychiatric Assessment Mastery bridges the gap between textbook theory and real-world clinical practice. Designed specifically for PMHNP students, registered nurses, and new practitioners, this practical workbook provides the scripts, templates, and decision-making frameworks needed to assess patients safely, efficiently, and with confidence. Rather than memorizing disconnected facts, you'll learn how to think clinically—from the first interview question to a well-reasoned diagnosis and clear documentation.

With this book, you will be able to:

Perform a structured, confident Mental Status Examination (MSE)

Write clear, exam-safe SOAP notes and treatment plans

Navigate DSM-5-TR diagnostic families with clinical reasoning

Identify risk factors and red flags that guide safe decision-making

Translate assessment findings into real-world clinical documentation



About The Author

Tonia Ojomo, MSN,BSN, RN.

Tonia Ojomo is an experienced psychiatric mental health nurse dedicated to clinical excellence. She created the Psychiatric Assessment Mastery system to help students and clinicians navigate the complexities of mental health evaluation with clarity, safety, and confidence.

For educational purposes only.

Not a substitute for clinical supervision or independent clinical judgment.